

PLAYA HERMOSA · GUANACASTE

Rocky Intertidal & Littoral Zone — Species Checklist

Source: Sibaja-Cordero & Cortés (2008), Revista de Biología Tropical · Bahía Salinas reference baseline

Common Name	Scientific Name	Zone	Seen ■	Photo ■	Notes
SECTION:BARNACLES					
Volcano barnacle	Tetraclita stalactifera	High / Mid			
Striped barnacle	Balanus amphitrite	Mid			
Chthamalus barnacle	Chthamalus panamensis	High			
SECTION:GASTROPODS					
Owl limpet	Lottia gigantea	High / Mid			
Ribbed limpet	Scurria viridula	Mid			
Nerite	Nerita scabricosta	High / Splash			
Periwinkle	Littorina aspera	Splash / High			
Periwinkle	Littorina modesta	High			
Purpura snail	Plicopurpura pansa	Mid			
Dove snail	Columbella fuscata	Low / Mid			
Horn snail	Cerithium stercusmuscarum	Low			
Top shell	Tegula sp.	Low / Mid			
SECTION:BIVALVES					
Ribbed mussel	Brachidontes semilaevis	Mid / Low			
Rock oyster	Saccostrea palmula	Low / Mid			
Chiton bivalve	Chama buddiana	Low			
SECTION:CHITONS					
Chiton	Chiton articulatus	Mid / Low			
Chiton	Ischnochiton muscarius	Low			
SECTION:OTHER INVERTEBRATES					
Sally lightfoot crab	Grapsus grapsus	High / Splash			
Hermit crab	Clibanarius panamensis	Mid / Low			
Purple sea urchin	Echinometra vanbrunti	Low			
Sea urchin	Arbacia incisa	Low			
Brittle star	Ophiocoma alexandri	Low / Subtidal			
Aggregating anemone	Bunodosoma californicum	Mid / Low			
Acorn worm / Polychaete	Various spp.	Low			
SECTION:MACROALGAE					

Coralline algae (encrusting)	Lithophyllum sp.	Mid / Low			
Green alga	Ulva lactuca	Mid / Low			
Green alga	Chaetomorpha sp.	Low / Pools			
Red alga	Laurencia sp.	Low / Pools			
Cyanobacterial mat	Various spp.	High / Splash			

Dry season (Dec–Apr): upwelling active · cooler SST · higher salinity · increased productivity · denser barnacle/limpet cover

Wet season (May–Nov): upwelling reduced · warmer SST · algal bloom · expanded macroalgae · greater gastropod mobility

Zones: Splash = above MHHW · High = MHHW to MTL · Mid = MTL to MLLW · Low = MLLW to subtidal · Pools = isolated at low tide

Reference: Sibaja-Cordero J.A. & Cortés J. (2008). Temporal variation in rocky intertidal communities, NW Costa Rica. Rev. Biol. Trop. 56(Suppl. 4): 107–131.